

Notes from a Moving Silence

I spent most of my free time at Tokashiku Beach. A place that felt almost unreal.

A place where birds crossed paths with whales. Where octopuses met the crescent moon. Where the foam of the ocean blended into the clouds.

Those clouds I would watch for hours, lying on the white remains of parrotfish, scattered across the sand.

We gave them names. Or at least, we tried to. It didn't matter much.

What struck me most was their speed. They moved across the East China Sea faster than anything I had ever seen, even faster than those pesky F-16 jets.

But lately, it was the opposite kind that held my attention.

Slow, heavy clouds. Thick, almost motionless. They could stay there for hours without changing, without drifting.

They weren't threatening. They weren't even particularly beautiful.

They were just there.

Waiting, quietly, like notes from a moving silence..